Bangladesh Mobile Financial Services Fraud & APP Scam Evidence Report

Checked public-source snapshot: 2026-10-07. This is not live data.

Executive summary

Thamun targets manipulated customer-authorized payments before final authorization. Public ecosystem statistics establish scale; case reports and consumer-protection coverage establish related risks. They do not establish Thamun effectiveness or national APP prevalence.

Evidence limitations and research gap

Public Bangladesh sources do not consistently classify fraud as Authorized Push Payment (APP) fraud. Direct APP relevance, broader MFS fraud and supporting digital-security evidence are separated.

Thamun model evaluation uses synthetic/simulated transaction data and does not establish real-world MFS performance.

Curated evidence set, not a census of Bangladesh incidents. Unverified sources contribute no statistics.

The named December 2025 Payment Systems Report could not be fetched; no PDF statistics or page numbers were guessed. Official statistics below come from a separately verified Bangladesh Bank web table. Police national fraud figures were not verified. Article publication dates are not assumed to be exact incident dates.

Bangladesh MFS ecosystem, fraud context and case studies

A large payment ecosystem

February 2025: 671,340,910 transactions; value BDT 164,726.30 crore; active accounts 871.54 lac.

- Category: MFS Ecosystem; relevance: Ecosystem context.

- Source: Bangladesh Bank - MFS comparative summary: January and February 2025 (Tier 1).

- Publication date: Not supplied; observation/reporting date: 2025-02.

- Checked: 2026-10-07; locator: Industry Wise Information, rows 3, 6, 7 and 8.

- URL: https://www.bb.org.bd/en/index.php/financialactivity/mfsdata

- Supports: Payment scale and active-account counts for this reporting month.

- Does not establish: Accounts are not unique people; volume is not fraud prevalence. These values come from a web table, not the unavailable PDF.

- Thamun connection: Pre-authorization screening (design rationale, not measured prevention).

Consumer vulnerability and redress

PRI-hosted coverage describes a survey of 7,279 MFS users and reports roughly one in ten experienced fraud.

- Category: Consumer Protection; relevance: Broader MFS fraud relevance.

- Source: Policy Research Institute / FNF - DFS consumer protection webinar: hosted media coverage (Tier 2).

- Publication date: 2022-03-31; observation/reporting date: 2022-03-31.

- Checked: 2026-10-07; locator: Opening hosted Daily Star coverage, paragraphs 1-6.

- URL: https://www.pri-bd.org/news_and_events/media-coverage-of-the-pri-fnf-webinar-on-the-state-of-dfs-consumer-protection-in-bangladesh/

- Supports: Reported survey evidence of consumer-protection concerns.

- Does not establish: Historical survey coverage, not current national prevalence or an APP-only rate; no fresh representative study performed.

- Thamun connection: Clear explanations and financial education (design rationale, not measured prevention).

Manipulation can precede a payment

The article describes emotional manipulation persuading people to send money, alongside credential theft.

- Category: APP / Social Engineering; relevance: Direct APP relevance.

- Source: The Daily Star - MFS faces growing risk of fraud (Tier 3).

- Publication date: 2024-03-25; observation/reporting date: 2024-03-25.

- Checked: 2026-10-07; locator: Social engineering discussion attributed to DB officer.

- URL: https://www.thedailystar.net/business/news/mfs-faces-growing-risk-fraud-3574906

- Supports: Qualitative relevance of victim-authorized payments.

- Does not establish: Media account, not a verified national APP count or a single classified APP incident.

- Thamun connection: Purpose checks and pre-OTP pause (design rationale, not measured prevention).

Dighi bKash recovery

TBS reports BDT 162,000 recovered after a caller impersonated bKash staff and obtained an OTP.

- Category: Incident Case Studies; relevance: Broader MFS fraud relevance.

- Source: The Business Standard - DB recovers Tk1.62 lakh stolen from actor Dighi’s bKash account (Tier 3).

- Publication date: 2024-02-12; observation/reporting date: 2024-02-12.

- Checked: 2026-10-07; locator: Article body: recovery and impersonation account.

- URL: https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/db-recovers-tk162-lakh-stolen-actor-dighis-bkash-account-791602

- Supports: A reported impersonation and OTP-compromise case.

- Does not establish: Does not establish that the victim initiated a push payment; not classified as direct APP evidence.

- Thamun connection: Verification guidance; never share PINs or OTPs (design rationale, not measured prevention).

Faridpur impersonation investigation

TBS reports five arrests following alleged customer-care impersonation and PIN/OTP collection.

- Category: Incident Case Studies; relevance: Broader MFS fraud relevance.

- Source: The Business Standard - Mobile banking scam, laundering network busted in Faridpur, 5 held (Tier 3).

- Publication date: 2025-07-14; observation/reporting date: 2025-07-14.

- Checked: 2026-10-07; locator: Article body: joint operation and PIN/OTP collection.

- URL: https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/crime/mobile-banking-scam-laundering-network-busted-faridpur-5-held-1187736

- Supports: Reported broader MFS fraud investigation.

- Does not establish: No comparable total loss amount extracted; credential compromise is not necessarily APP fraud.

- Thamun connection: Recipient/context checks and verification education (design rationale, not measured prevention).

Stolen-device recovery

BSS reporting carried by TBS describes 363 recovered phones returned to owners.

- Category: Digital Security; relevance: Supporting digital-security evidence.

- Source: BSS via The Business Standard - Police return 363 stolen mobile phones to owners (Tier 3).

- Publication date: 2025-01-29; observation/reporting date: 2025-01-29.

- Checked: 2026-10-07; locator: BSS byline and opening phone-recovery paragraphs.

- URL: https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/police-return-363-stolen-mobile-phones-owners-1055756

- Supports: Supporting digital-security context.

- Does not establish: Phone counts are not scam-victim counts or APP statistics; excluded from the MFS case timeline count.

- Thamun connection: Security education and account-access safeguards (design rationale, not measured prevention).

Statistical analysis

Monthly transaction value change, January-February 2025: (164726.3 − 171664.12) / 171664.12 × 100 = -4.04%.

Source: Bangladesh Bank MFS web table, rows 7-8. Unequal month lengths affect totals. Two observations do not establish a long-term trend. No national fraud percentage, incident-loss sum, or money-saved estimate is calculated.

The dashboard case count includes only items explicitly flagged as MFS incident case studies. Source-tier counts include only verified source records, not inaccessible URLs or independent corroborations. Registered/active accounts are not interchangeable with unique people.

Source quality and verification gaps

Tier 1: official; Tier 2: institutional/research; Tier 3: established media. PRI is an institutional host of media coverage, not a freshly inspected microdataset. BSS attribution is syndicated reporting at TBS, not an independently verified BSS page. Media allegations remain attributed allegations.

Bangladesh Bank: MFS comparative summary: January and February 2025

Status: verified. Tier 1. Published: Not supplied. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Historical web table, not current-month live data; publication date not supplied.

https://www.bb.org.bd/en/index.php/financialactivity/mfsdata

Bangladesh Bank: Payment Systems Report - December 2025

Status: unverified. Tier 1. Published: Not supplied. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Fetch timed out. No values or PDF page claims extracted.

https://www.bb.org.bd/pub/annual/psdreport/paymentreport_dec2025.pdf

Bangladesh Police: Official fraud evidence verification

Status: unverified. Tier 1. Published: Not supplied. Checked: 2026-10-07.

No exact national MFS/APP fraud statistic verified from the provided official source.

https://www.police.gov.bd/

Policy Research Institute / FNF: DFS consumer protection webinar: hosted media coverage

Status: verified. Tier 2. Published: 2022-03-31. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Institutional host of media summaries of a PRI survey; underlying microdata/methodology not independently inspected.

https://www.pri-bd.org/news_and_events/media-coverage-of-the-pri-fnf-webinar-on-the-state-of-dfs-consumer-protection-in-bangladesh/

The Daily Star: MFS faces growing risk of fraud

Status: verified. Tier 3. Published: 2024-03-25. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Canonical page denied access; text verified on publisher image-domain mirror.

https://www.thedailystar.net/business/news/mfs-faces-growing-risk-fraud-3574906

Publisher mirror used for verification:
https://tds-images.thedailystar.net/business/news/mfs-faces-growing-risk-fraud-3574906

The Business Standard: DB recovers Tk1.62 lakh stolen from actor Dighi’s bKash account

Status: verified. Tier 3. Published: 2024-02-12. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Source article text checked; no independent investigation performed.

https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/db-recovers-tk162-lakh-stolen-actor-dighis-bkash-account-791602

The Business Standard: Mobile banking scam, laundering network busted in Faridpur, 5 held

Status: verified. Tier 3. Published: 2025-07-14. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Source article text checked; no independent investigation performed.

https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/crime/mobile-banking-scam-laundering-network-busted-faridpur-5-held-1187736

BSS via The Business Standard: Police return 363 stolen mobile phones to owners

Status: verified. Tier 3. Published: 2025-01-29. Checked: 2026-10-07.

Syndicated BSS article verified at TBS, not a separately verified BSS website page.

https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/police-return-363-stolen-mobile-phones-owners-1055756

BSS: Additional MFS case search

Status: unverified. Tier 3. Published: Not supplied. Checked: 2026-10-07.

No separate relevant direct BSS article verified; syndicated BSS coverage is listed separately.

https://www.bssnews.net/

Bangladesh Bank: Economic data portal

Status: not_used. Tier 1. Published: Not supplied. Checked: 2026-10-07.

No additional economic series needed for this scoped evidence set.

https://www.bb.org.bd/en/index.php/econdata/index

Why Thamun is relevant

Pre-authorization explanation and purpose inquiry provide a place to reconsider manipulated payments. Recipient history and appropriately qualified reports add context. Adaptive intervention aims to limit unnecessary disruption; that benefit requires evaluation. Coaching can support understanding without shaming the customer.

The simulated prototype does not integrate with live wallets or prevent OTP theft outside its payment flow. Real customer evaluation, provider integration, representative APP labels and deployment/legal review remain necessary.

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